

to unlock things like concept art, landmarks, and even cool costumes.

The game uses the 3D Comic Inking Technology, a cartoon-style 3D Cel Shader. The effect is an awesome mix of the two—standard 3D effects like dynamic lighting and shadows, and the brilliant-looking comic style, especially appealing in Venom. Cutscenes are also presented in comic-style panels, bringing the theme full circle.

What *really* sets this game apart is that you'll be doing missions as Spider-Man *and* as Venom! The two characters have really different fighting styles—Spidey's agile, acrobatic moves and Venom's raw, brute force keeps you entertained no end. After you've finished the story missions, you can free-roam the city and switch between the two. Playing as Venom is no less fun

than as Spidey himself—you can throw cars, slap cops around, and generally descend upon Manhattan with carnage on your mind. He's deadly strong, so you don't need us to tell you how entertaining this can be!

The acid-test for the game developer is the oh-so-critical web-swinging, and Treyarch pass with flying colours. It gets the adrenaline circulating nice and strong without being too disorienting or difficult. Getting used to the keyboard layout takes time, and it's probably a good idea to tweak the controls to something you're more comfortable with; but while this helps to get comfortable with the web-swinging, it still doesn't help the combat much. In short, you'll need a game controller to get the best out of this one.

Rating: 8/10

Minimum System Requirements

Windows 2000/XP

Pentium 4 @ 1.4GHz/Athlon 1500

256 MB RAM

32 MB DirectX 9.0 video card

Developer: Treyarch

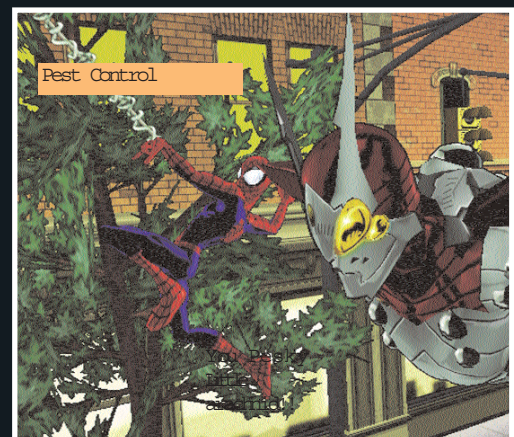
Publisher: Activision

Distributor: Worldwide CD ROMs

Contact:

022-56973895

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After a long day of crimefighting, Our Hero ponders his next Challenge

